

25 August 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

Meituan's push into Dubai quick-commerce — and building a fresh fruits & vegetables category from a strong imported base — is exactly the kind of category-and-commercial challenge I'm drawn to, so the Fresh Category Manager (F&V) role caught my attention. Category strategy, assortment and promotional planning, commercial negotiation and quick-commerce operations are the spine of my career, I'm Dubai-based, and I bring an Alibaba (Miravia) e-commerce grounding that resonates with how Meituan builds.

My background is squarely category and commercial. At Alibaba's Miravia I led category expansion as PIC Fragrances — building supplier and partner relationships, onboarding 30+ stores in two months, and managing 42 accounts against P&L targets to grow GMV +30% QoQ through pricing, assortment and promotions. Before that I ran Category Planning for chocolate at Mondelez (sell-in/sell-out, promotional effectiveness, turnover). Today at DoFreeze I own category, assortment and go-to-market strategy across 50+ markets, negotiate with distributors and modern-trade partners, integrate the portfolio into UAE quick-commerce (Noon, Talabat, Careem, Deliveroo), and turn forecasting, market and competition data into working category and promotional plans — coordinating cross-functionally with supply, logistics and marketing. That mix — category methods, negotiation, data-led decisions and quick-commerce / e-commerce operations — is precisely what this role runs on.

I want to be transparent about where I'd be ramping. My categories have been FMCG, beauty, fragrances and fashion rather than fresh produce, and while I coordinate closely with logistics and supply, I haven't personally owned fresh-produce import procedures, customs clearance or cross-border cold-chain — I'd get up to speed on those quickly and lean on the specialists around me. What I bring instead is a strong, transferable category-and-commercial craft, genuine quick-commerce and e-commerce depth in this market, sharp negotiation and data analysis, and a generative-AI edge (Claude/GPT) that accelerates market research and category insight. My English is business-level C1 (I don't speak Mandarin or Arabic).

I'd welcome the chance to talk through how I'd approach the first 90 days — mapping the imported F&V assortment and supplier landscape, building the category and promotional plan to grow turnover and reduce waste, and coordinating procurement, logistics and marketing to launch and scale cleanly. I'm already based in Dubai and available for on-site work, I bring real category, commercial and quick-commerce depth, and I'd be genuinely excited to help Meituan build fresh in the UAE. Thank you for considering my application.

Best regards,

Paula De Francisco Pérez

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